

Emergency Triage

If the scene is unsafe — move yourself away from fire, traffic, violence, electrical hazards, chemicals, smoke, or other danger if you can. Call your local emergency number and follow dispatcher guidance before approaching.

If someone is unconscious and not breathing normally — gasping or not breathing at all — call your local emergency number, put the phone on speaker, send someone for an AED if available, and start CPR immediately.

[Open CPR guide →](#)

What do you see?

☹️ **Can't breathe, speak, or cough**

Person is clutching their throat, turning blue, or making high-pitched sounds.

[Choking guide →](#)

Heavy bleeding

Blood is spurting, pooling, soaking through bandages, or the limb is severed.

[Severe Bleeding guide →](#)

Sudden face droop, arm weakness, slurred speech

Or sudden severe headache, confusion, trouble seeing, or loss of balance.

[Stroke guide →](#)

Cannot wake, slow or abnormal breathing after possible opioid use

Possible opioid overdose. Call emergency services, give naloxone if available, and support breathing/follow dispatcher guidance.

[Opioid Overdose guide →](#)

Confusion, fainting, very hot skin

In hot weather or after exertion. Could be heat stroke.

[Extreme Heat guide →](#)

Coughing, chest tightness, smoky air

During a wildfire or heavy air pollution. Vulnerable people at highest risk.

[Wildfire Smoke guide →](#)

Vomiting, diarrhea, very thirsty, dark urine

Signs of dehydration. Especially dangerous for children and older adults.

Dehydration & ORS guide →

Trouble breathing, swelling, or faintness after allergen exposure

Possible anaphylaxis: call emergency services, use epinephrine if indicated by an action plan/product/local responder rules, and position safely.

Severe Allergy guide →

Burn from fire, hot liquid, or chemical

Cool under running water for 20 minutes if possible, cover loosely, and do not use ice or home remedies.

Burns guide →

✂ Rigid jerking, loss of consciousness

Seizure. Protect the head, time it, do not restrain or put anything in the mouth.

Seizure guide →

General first steps for any emergency

- 1 Check safety.** If unsafe, move away and call for help before approaching.
- 2 Check responsiveness.** Tap their shoulder and shout. No response + not breathing normally → CPR.
- 3 Call for help.** Call your local emergency number. Put the phone on speaker so the dispatcher can guide you.
- 4 Use the guide above** that matches what you see, while following dispatcher/local guidance.

This is a quick-reference aid, not a substitute for first-aid training. When in doubt about a serious or rapidly worsening symptom, call your local emergency number. Verify guidance against your local health authority.

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